

Questions - Part 4: Can you? Do you?

A Quick-Reference Guide

For: Ability, Habit, Preference, and Four Tenses [Past, Present, Future, and Present-Perfect (Schedule-Tense)]

Example Actions: Sing, Cook, Read, Molt, Skiing, Cooking French Soup,

Q	A
Question Patterns	Answer Patterns

#	Focus	Question	Answers (+)	Answer (-)
1	Ability	Can you _____? (no "ed" or "ing")	Yes, I can.	No, I can't.
2.1	Any Time	Do you _____? (no "ed" or "ing")	Yes, I do. Sometimes.	No, I don't.
2.2	Frequency	*Do you _____ often?	Yes, I do. Sometimes.	No, I don't.
3	Now	Are you _____ing (now)?	Yes, I am.	No, I'm not. No, not right now.
4.1	Skill Level	Can you _____ well?	Maybe. Yes, I <u>can</u> .	No, not very (<u>well</u>).
4.2	Skill Level	Are you good at _____ing?	Yes, I <u>am</u> . A little.	No, not very (<u>good</u>). No, I'm not.
5	Cycle	When do you _____?	I (sometimes) _____ in the Spring. I _____ at night.	I don't usually _____.
6.1	Past	When did you last <u>(present form)</u> ?	I (last) <u>ed</u> [time]. (I last saw a boat race four years ago.) or [time only]	I haven't ever _____.
6.2	Past	When was the last time you <u>(past form)</u> ?	I (last) <u>ed</u> [time]. (I last saw a boat race four years ago.) or [time only]	I haven't ever _____.
7	One Time	Have you ever <u>(past form)</u> ?	Yes, I have.	(No,) I have never <u>ed</u> . No, I haven't (ever _____).
8.1	Frequency	How often do you _____?	Sometimes/Everyday	Never.
8.2	Frequency	Do you <i>*ever</i> _____?	Sometimes/Everyday	Never.
8.3	Frequency	Do you _____ <i>*ever</i> ?	Sometimes/Everyday	Never.
9	Past	Did you _____ (optional: specific time) ?	Yes, I did.	No, I didn't.
10	Future	Will you _____ (optional: specific time) ?	Yes, I will.	No, I won't.
11.1	Future	When will you next _____?	I will <u>(action)</u> <u>(time)</u> .	I don't plan to _____.
11.2	Future	When are you going to _____?	I will <u>(action)</u> <u>(time)</u> . I don't know yet.	I don't plan to _____. I don't have (any) plan(s) yet.
12	Like	Do you like to _____?	Yes, I do.	No, I don't.

Notes

- *Frequency: You can use any of these words = often, ever, sometimes, occasionally, etc.
- The meaning of #4 and #5 is the same, but the **wording of the answers** must be different.
- The **negative** forms of the questions can have different meanings. Some are not commonly used.
[See: Quick Reference Questions Part 5 Negative Questions - Negative Can you Do you]
 Don't you like to _____? = Do you really not like _____?
 When don't you _____? = You often _____. (a statement, not a question)
 Not used/Have no meaning:
~~When didn't you last (present form) ?~~ ~~When won't you next _____?~~
~~When wasn't the last time you _____?~~ ~~When aren't you going to _____?~~ ~~How often don't you _____?~~
- "What" can be added to questions 1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 9, 10, & 12. (E.g. #10: What will you do?)